



DS Technical Case

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Optimize coupon offers to convert casual customers and improve customer lifetime value

Causal Models and Short-Term Proxies unlock a long-term customer engagement strategy

(Methodology)

- **From Correlation to Causation:** Shifting from classic ML (which only identifies associations) to a causal framework that captures true cause-and-effect.
- **The Limitation of Traditional Test Analysis:** Since we have many test parameters, standard methods like ANOVA fail due to the impossibility of creating clean comparison groups.
- **The Causal Solution:** Causal models learn the impact of each parameter, enabling data-driven optimization despite high complexity.

(Time window)

- **Short-Term Proxies:** Leveraging a 30-day window and short-term metrics to measure initial impact across multiple offers.
- **Long-Term Validation:** Continuously testing if these early metrics reliably predict our long-term goals as more data becomes available.

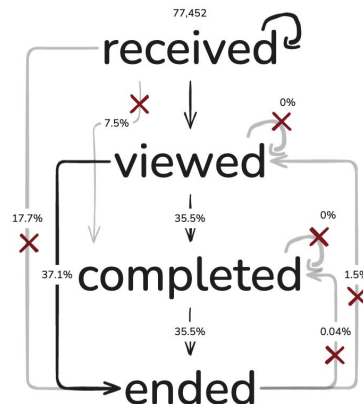
Transforming Event Data to Offer-Level for Causal Modeling

Data Transformations

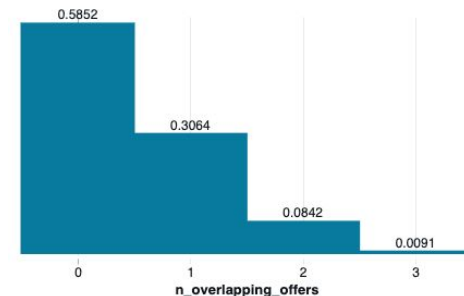
- **FIFO**: First-In-First-Out logic to link transactions events to a specific offer
This selects 99.5% of the initial offer count (77k)
- **Non-compliance**: Remove non-viewed offers (72.6%)
- **More than one treatment**: Remove offers that are overlapping (58.5%)
- **Target Censorship**: Remove offers with fewer than 4 days between the next offer or last day (33.6%)

After applying all filters, 20,901 out of 77,452 offers were selected (27%) to create this model

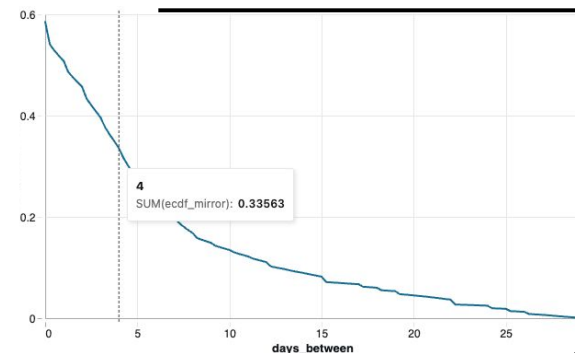
Offer States



Percentage of overlapping offers



P(Days Between Offers > x)



Causal Modeling Pipeline & Technical Definitions

To control confounders, we used the backdoor criterion, adding customer and communication data to the model.

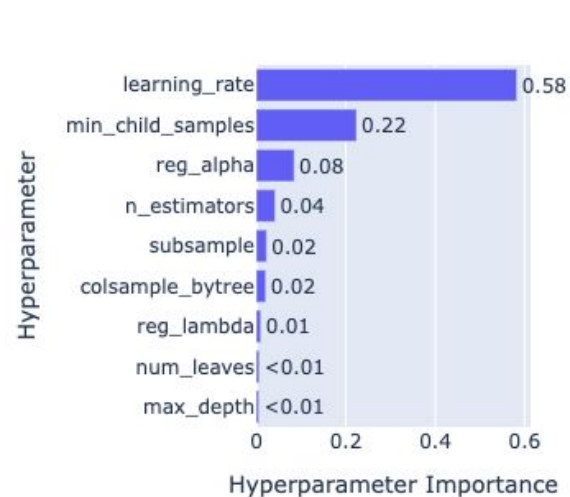
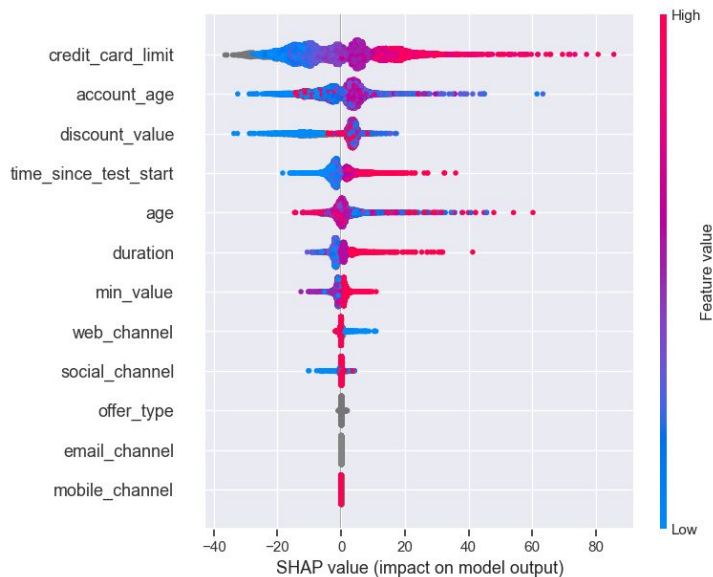
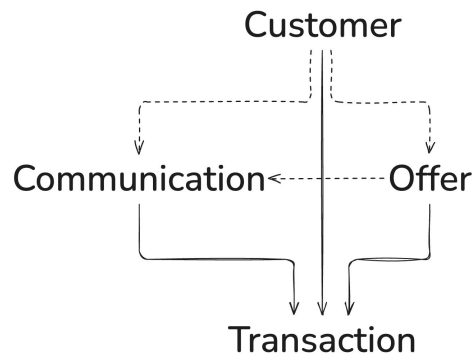
We developed two models: 1) customer information only, and 2) all information. Gender was excluded for fairness.

Model Stack: We used an LGBM Regressor, Optuna for hyperparameter optimization, and SHAP for feature impact analysis

Structural Causal Model (DAG)

-----> Path to control

-----> Path to learn



Financial Results

Maximizes ROI early: The green curve rises steeply, proving we can capture roughly 70% of our total business value by targeting only the top 50% of the population.

Proves Causal Advantage: Our final_model consistently outperforms the traditional, non-causal approach (orange line).

